A Statistical Predictors of Victory in Competitive Overwatch

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Data Source

This dataset contains aggregated match data from the Overwatch Champions Series (OWCS), played on FaceIT servers across the EMEA and NA regions.

Story

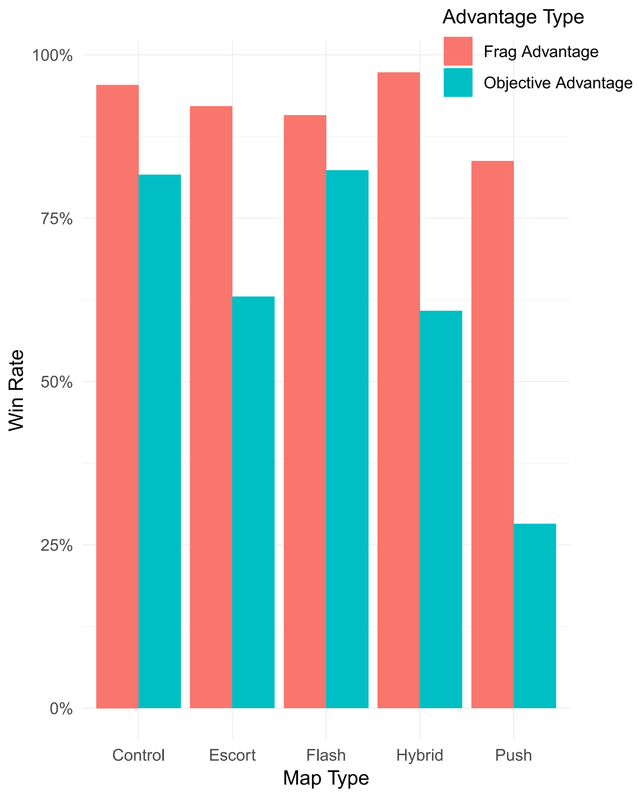
Conventional Overwatch strategy suggests that physically controlling the point is the primary path to victory. However, the data from the highest levels of play (OWCS) tells a sharper, more aggressive story. The analysis reveals that aggression wins games.

Teams that prioritize securing kills have a significantly higher win rate than those who focus on objective time. Furthermore, the data exposes the existence of "Empty Stats", metrics like Healing and Damage Mitigated that look good on the scoreboard but have virtually zero correlation with actually winning a match.

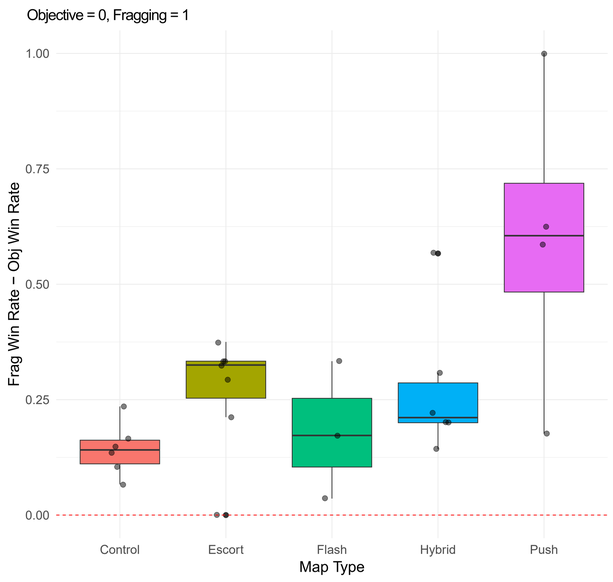
Audience

This analysis is designed for Overwatch coaches, analysts, and competitive players looking to optimize team strategy. Understanding that objective time is a byproduct of victory, as opposed to being the sole cause, helps players make better decisions in the heat of battle.

How consistent is the 'Fragging Strategy' across different modes?

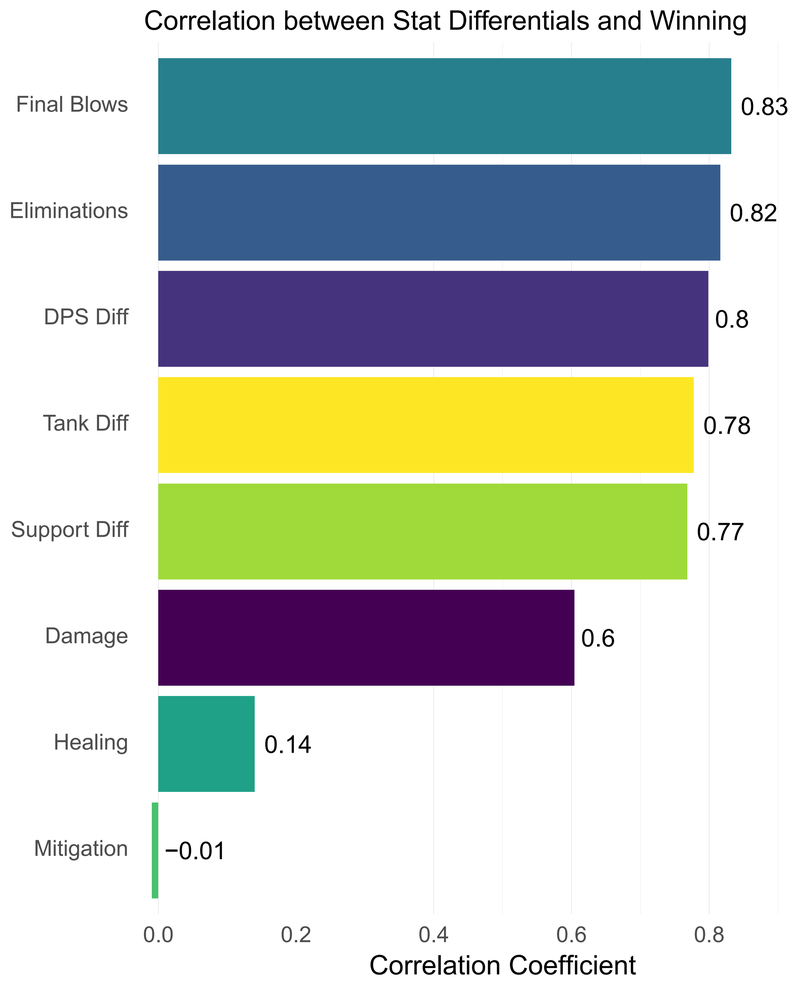


Comparing the averages reveals that while Objective Advantage is helpful, it is consistently outperformed by Frag Advantage.



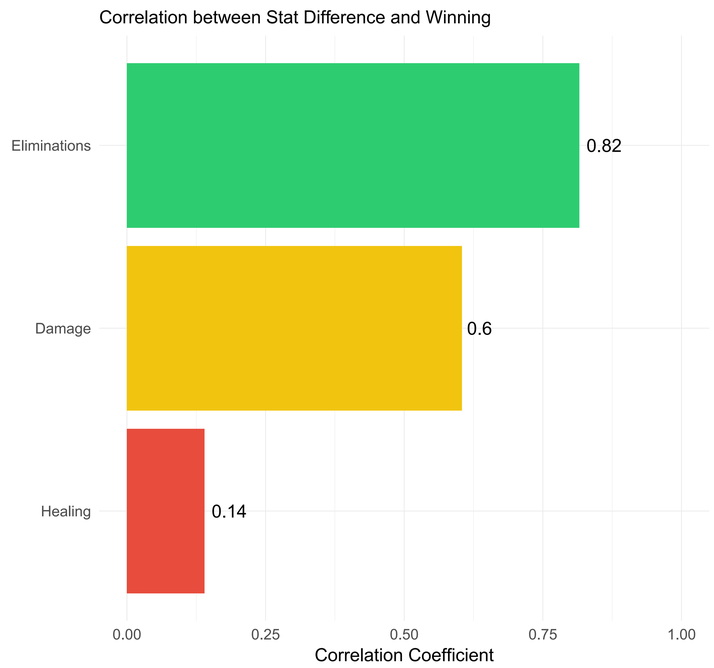
The consistently positive distribution confirms that Frag Advantage is a reliable win condition across most modes, with Push and Flashpoint varying the most.

Key Question: What is the single strongest statistical predictor of victory in competitive Overwatch?



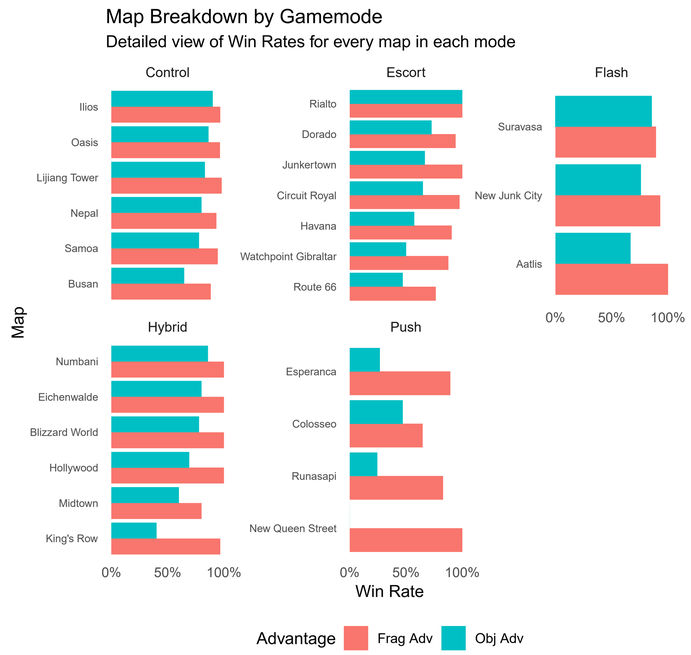
Analysis shows DPS Diff > Tank Diff. Mitigation is irrelevant.

Securing Final Blows and Eliminations is the strongest statistical predictor of winning, proving that 'empty stats' like Healing and Mitigation have negligible impact on the final outcome.

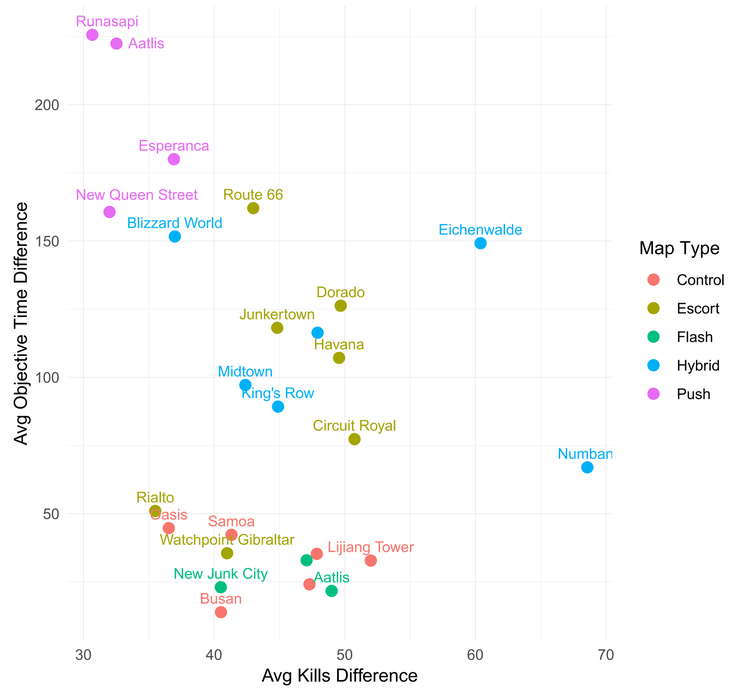


This breakdown isolates the specific stat gaps that determine match outcomes, highlighting that efficient eliminations outweighs passive value.

Can a team win by dominating the Objective even if they are losing in kills?



A granular look across all game modes confirms that Frag Advantage consistently yields a higher win rate than Objective Advantage, with only Control maps showing a slightly tighter competition between the two.



Specific map types allow for varying levels of objective control.

R Packages: readr, dplyr, tidyr, ggplot2, scales